

Memo: replacing the routing bot

To Ritu Deshpande, Head of D2C Operations
From the service-routing project team (via Kabir Nanda)
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THE DECISION

Switch the bot off. Replace it with our router, which sends each request to the team that actually solves it. When a message is too vague to route, the router asks the customer one quick question instead of guessing.

THE NUMBER

77 / 100 requests the bot sends to the right team today	86 / 100 our router, when it has to answer every request on its own	97 / 100 right on the 84 in 100 requests that say clearly what's wrong	16 / 100 too vague to route, so they get one question instead of a guess
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You asked for a 90% match with the bot's labels. We can do that (we measured 94%), but it only copies the bot's mistakes: just 81 of 100 would reach the right team. So we measured against **where each request was actually resolved**.

THE RUPEES (PER YEAR, ABOUT 8,500 REQUESTS)

	Today	With the router
Misrouting: about 1.4 transfers × Rs 305, plus Rs 260 for the extra customer contact, so about Rs 692 each	Rs 14.6 lakh	Rs 1.3–4.8 lakh*
Bot licence	Rs 3.2 lakh	Rs 0
Running cost	in the licence	Rs 0: runs on an ordinary office computer, with no per-request fee
Total	Rs 17.8 lakh	Rs 1.3–4.8 lakh, saving about Rs 13–16 lakh

*The high end assumes every question to a customer costs as much as a full extra contact.

HOW WE GOT THERE

- Checked the labels first.** We compared the bot's choice with the team that closed each request, and 1 in 4 was wrong. *"I paid for installation but the installer didn't come". The bot sent it to Billing; Installs & Demo solved it.*
- Cleaned the export.** We merged the renamed teams, fixed the garbled Zoho text ("*urgĀ©nt*" became "urgent"), and corrected Zoho times that were stored in UTC.
- Taught the router from real outcomes.** From 10,822 past requests it learned which words point to which team. *"gone blank" and "error code" point to Repairs; "filter" and "AMC kit" point to Filters.*
- Tested it fairly.** We trained it on older months and tested it on three later quarters it had never seen. It scored 85–86% every time.
- Learned from its mistakes.** When a customer asks two things, the last one decides. *"Spare blade available? Mixer showing error E7" goes to Repairs.*
- Found the limit.** 16 in 100 say nothing useful, like *"please call me about my purifier"*. These ended up with all seven teams in roughly equal shares, so no system can route them from the text. The router asks instead.
- Tried and dropped** more complex models, hand-written keyword lists, and a new AI decision model (Jev, for which we had no access key). They gave no gain, or couldn't be measured.

WHAT TO DO NEXT WEEK

- Run the router alongside the bot** on live requests for two weeks, compare the results daily, and switch the bot off at renewal.
- Set up the automatic question** for vague requests: a WhatsApp, email or SMS reply saying "reply 1–7". If there's no reply within 4 hours, the request goes to the best guess, flagged for the agent to check.
- Plan headcount on the real numbers.** The bot's labels overstate Repairs (206 vs 165 a month), Billing (113 vs 90) and Filters (95 vs 73). They understate Returns (81 vs 106), Installs (78 vs 104) and Warranty (67 vs 89).
- Ask Tanmay to add** customer ID, delivery date and open tickets to the export. With those, many vague requests can be routed without asking.